The ultimate guide to creating a new community on Reddit

The ultimate guide to creating a community

Your adventure as a moderator begins here. This guide will assist in your quest to build a community on Reddit. Along the way it'll help you navigate choppy waters and even point the way to a crew, hearty and true, to join you on your exploration.

You may discover the greatest treasure is not in karma and gold, but in the friendships you make along the way. So hoist your sails and let the spirit of adventure carry you forth.

Table of contents

4 What's a mod?

6 Community banners

8 Community icons

9 Community descriptions

10 Community rules

12 Making your first five posts

14 Flair

16 Community status

18 Scheduling a post

20 5 settings you should know

22 Finding your people

24 Staying safe as a moderator

26 Mod Tools Dictionary

28 New mod FAQs

30 Resources available to you

What's a Reddit moderator?

Moderators, or "mods," are volunteer redditors who create communities or join existing communities, and help ensure that the communities are fun, interesting, and well-organized places to discuss and share content with other redditors.

Good listener

Leads with heart

Things mods can do

- Create the look and feel of the community
- Invite people to join the community
- Set the rules and enforce posting and commenting guidelines
- Remove and approve posts/comments
- Grant user flair and post flair
- Lock threads or comments from receiving more comments and replies
- Ban spammers or other redditors who may be breaking community rules from their community

Things mods can’t do

- See the individual list of subscribers to the community
- Spam redditors about the new community
- Edit other redditors submissions or comments
- Know who voted on things in the community
- Know who reported things in the community

Community banners

Set the mood with a banner

Welcome home to your new community. First things first: paint the front door and make your community look welcoming by setting a **community banner**. The banner visual in your community sets the tone for the space, which can help redditors decide if they're interested in joining.

A good banner might...

Restate your community name

Reflect the mood of your community

Powering up your community

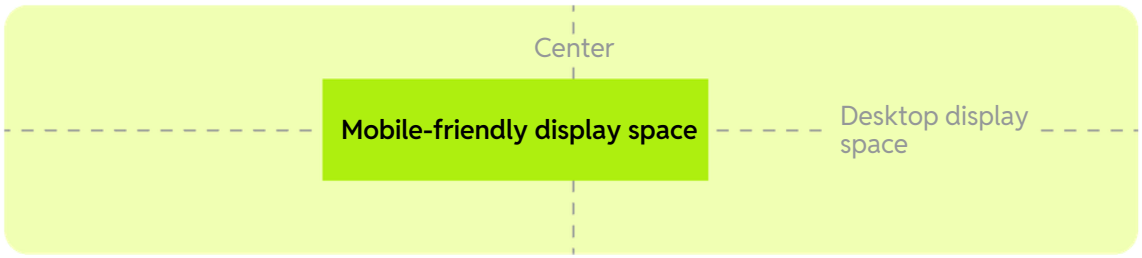
Keep it simple or get creative — the choice is yours!

r/ElvenFood keeps it simple and uses a forest backdrop

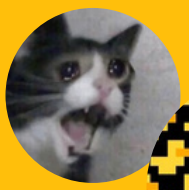
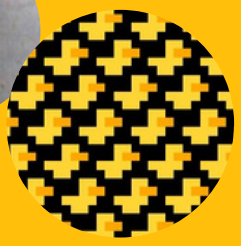
A couple icons and a title do the job for **r/Jobs** banner

Mod pro tip:

For good results, use an image that is at least 1600x480. Any text should be aligned slightly left of center in the mobile friendly display space.



Community icons

Make it iconic

Power-up your community by setting a **community icon**. It can be as simple as choosing a background color and adding a symbol to represent your topic.

Take a look at your favorite communities to get inspired.

Mod pro tip:

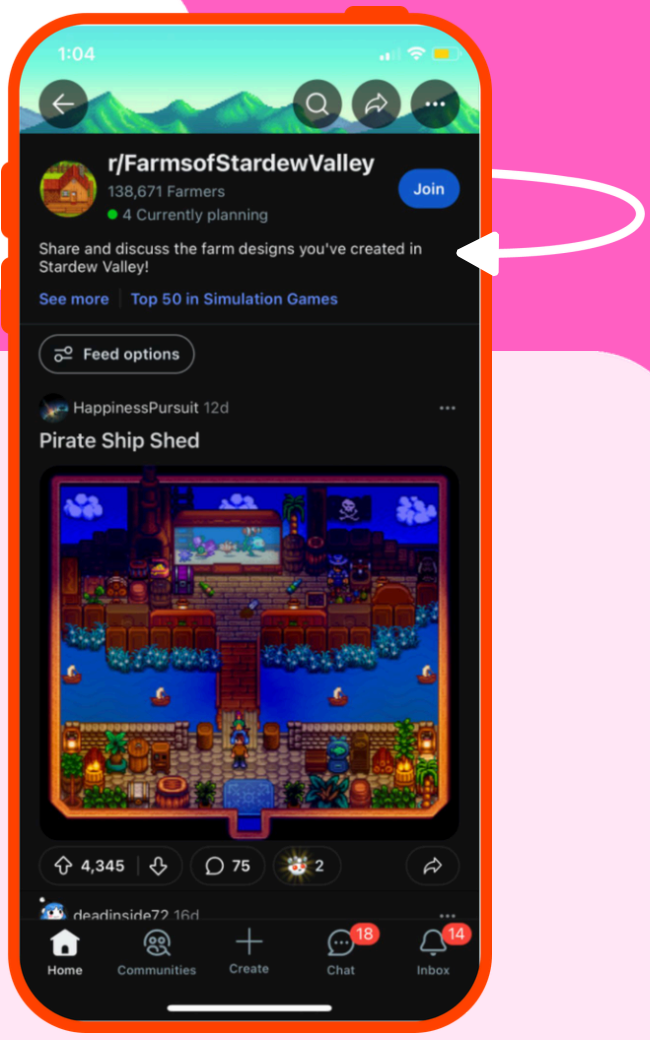
Optimal icon size is 500x500.

Powering up your community

Community descriptions

Describe your community

Your **community description** is the place where you tell the world who your community is for and what they can post.



A good description...

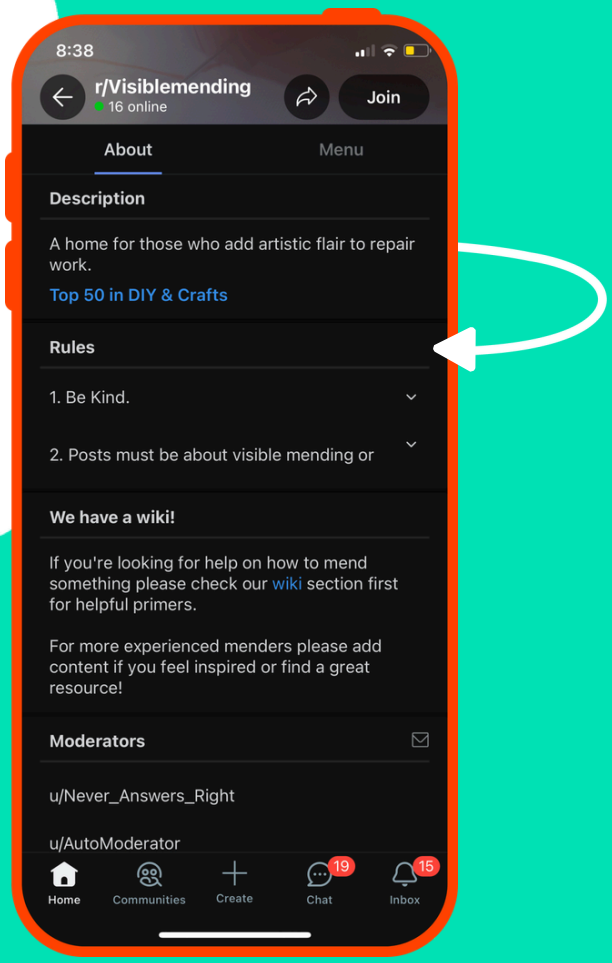
- States the topic of your community
- Helps people understand what they can post
- Is welcoming to visitors

Powering up your community

Community rules

Set community rules

Community rules tell others how they should expect to participate in your community. You can add rules over time as your community grows. One rule new communities might add is a rule about being kind and respectful. This can help set the right welcoming tone for your community.



Powering up your community

A good set of rules for a new community:

1. Sets the tone for how people should engage your community
2. Can evolve with the community's input over time
3. Are simple enough that folks still feel like they can contribute

"Our rules keep changing as the sub grows. We ensure our rules and reasons behind why we have a particular rule, is explained to all members."

— **r/BollywoodBlindsNGossip** mod **u/EccentricBai**

Making your first five posts

Now that you've completed the basics...

It's time to fill your community with at least five posts. Doing so will help unlock your Community Rating faster, allowing you to be found by redditors. New communities that have more posts also entice people who find your community to subscribe!

Mod pro tip:

Set a reminder to visit your community every week and make a new post. It's important you come back regularly to add new content that can be discovered.

What should I post to my community?

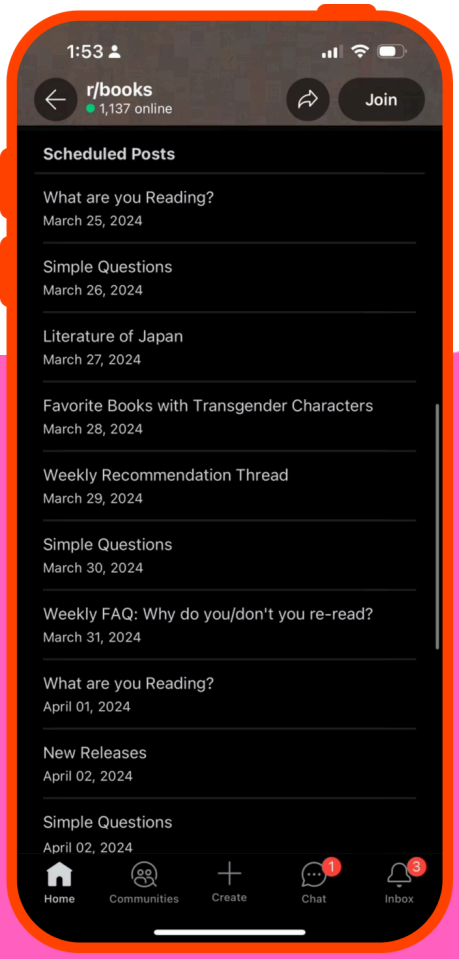
- Look at related communities for **inspiration**. What type of content is being posted every day and how might you create something similar?
- **Make a poll**. People love sharing their opinion!
- **Create a 'Welcome' post**. Tell others what your community is all about and who it's for.
- Create a **meme**!
- Look up **common questions** people have about your topic. Create a post that answers the question. This will help your community show up in search results!
- Share a recent **news article** about your topic.
- **Ask a thought-provoking question** that entices people to respond.
- **Make a 'Today I Learned' (TIL)** post about your topic.
- **Make a 'Top 5' list** for your topic and ask others to share their opinion.
- **Share a tip** or piece of advice with others.
- Look for related content in other communities and **repost content** into your community with a new caption.
- Think about what new people (vs those 'in the know') might want to discuss. **Make a post for the newbies** and answer their questions.

Scheduling a post

Easily plan posts ahead of time

The **scheduled posts** feature lets you “set it and forget it” when it comes to planning content for your community. Not only will this help you stay organized, it also offers flexibility to post at the times you want to – whether you’re online or not!

You can schedule the **date, time, time zone, and whether you want the post to be recurring** (like a weekly welcome thread for new community members).



Flair

What is flair?

Flair is a creative way for members to badge their posts and create an identity within their community.

It's a special tagging system that you can choose to enable for your community. **There are two types of flair:**

Post flair

Post flair allows mods and members to add tags to content and easily filter through content and conversations. Depending on your community, you might decide to get creative and make flair fun, or keep things simple.

🔧 You can set up post flair by navigating to **Mod Tools > Content > Manage Flair.**

User flair

You can choose whether you set user flair or whether subscribers can set their own flair in your community. You can think of User Flair as a fun way for users to create or tag themselves as a unique identity in your community.

🔧 You can set up user flair by navigating to **Mod Tools > User Flair.**

Flair examples:

Post flair

r/casualconversation

POST FLAIR

Mod Post | Neat | Weekly Topic | Gaming | Just Chatting | Music | Movies & Shows | Food & Drinks | Pets & Animals | Books & Reading | Life Stories | Questions | Thoughts & Ideas | Made did it

r/cats

SORT BY FLAIR

Cat Picture | Video | Cat Talk | Adoption | Announcement | Humor | Advice | Medical Questions | Mourning/Loss

User flair

r/writing

Select your community flair

- Author
- Published Author
- Self-Published Author
- Freelance Writer
- Career Author
- Career Writer
- Agent
- Agent - Children's Fiction
- Agent - Children's Non-Fiction
- Agent - Genre Fiction

Community status

Highlight what's top of mind

Community status is a way to share what's going on in your community. Setting a status adds a lively touch to your community and it's visible to all redditors. If someone clicks or taps your status, they can see the info you've put in this space.

🔧 To add a status, click the add emoji icon next to your community name. Simply add your text or a custom image or GIF (128 x 128px).

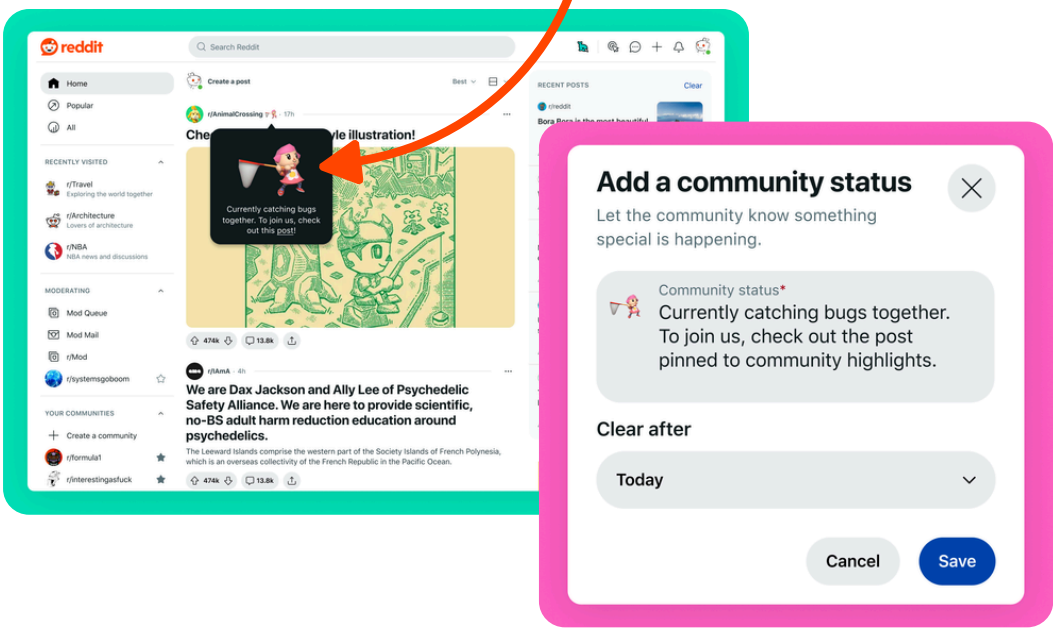
What might you use community status for?

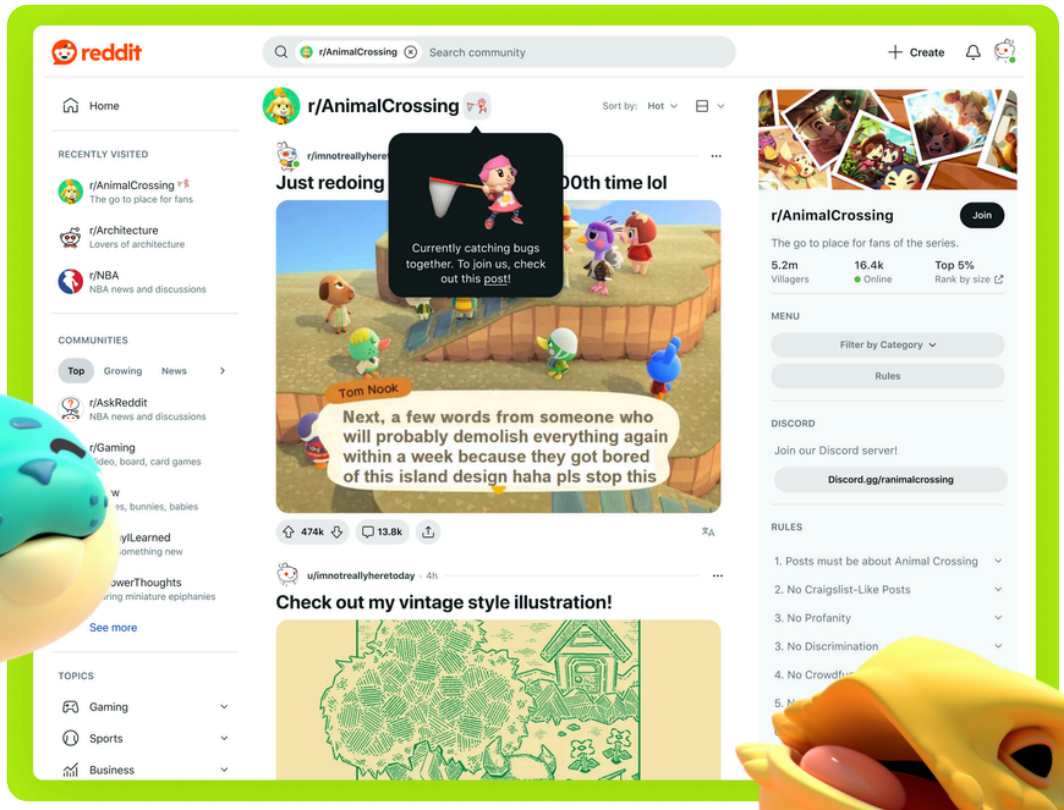
Highlight
a live event

Commemorate
a community milestone

Showcase
specific posts

Community status examples:



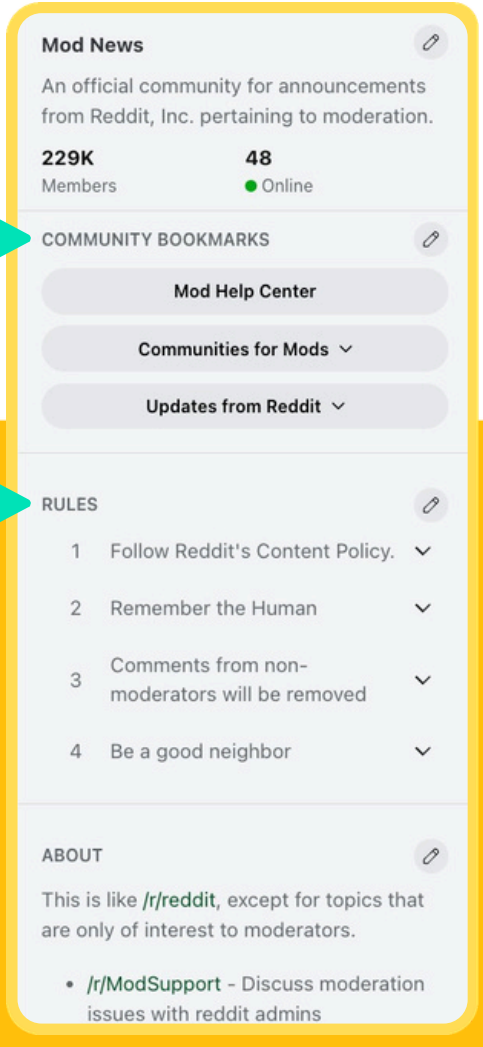


Sidebar

Customize your sidebar with info and resources

The **sidebar widget tool** allows you to add a variety of useful content to the right-hand sidebar of your community. It's an easy way to display your community's rules, add related links, explain the origins of the community, or just show off an ever changing array of handsome cat photos.

🔧 To access this tool, click Edit Widgets at the bottom of the right-hand sidebar of your community's page.



Widgets you can add to your community's sidebar:

- Text
- Bookmarks
- Buttons
- Images
- Community list
- Calendar
- Post flair
- Rules

Five settings you should know

1. New Post Notifications

Consider enabling the New Post Notification setting. Picture this: someone (who isn't you) posts something incredible to your subreddit, and voila! Immediately you get a notification that calls you into action. Engaging new posts makes contributors feel appreciated.

🔧 To activate this setting on mobile, navigate to **Mod Tools > Mod Notifications > Activity > New Posts and turn it on.**

2. Safety Tooling

Reddit has safety features already enabled for your community that prevent spam and block problematic users. You may choose to further enhance community safety by auto-collapsing comments and posts from users with negative karma, should they post in your community.

🔧 To configure this setting go to **Mod Tools > Safety > Crowd Control (Comments) (Posts) and set it to Lenient.**

3. Location Setting

If your subreddit is specific to a specific location or region, such as r/SocialParis or r/LigaMX, you can use the location setting to help your subreddit attract the right audience.

🔧 To set your community's location via mobile, go to **Mod Tools > Location > and add your relevant location details.**

4. Posting Guidelines

If you have a particular way you want people to contribute content to your community, you can create posting guidelines. Not every community needs guidelines you may decide to let your community post whatever they like!

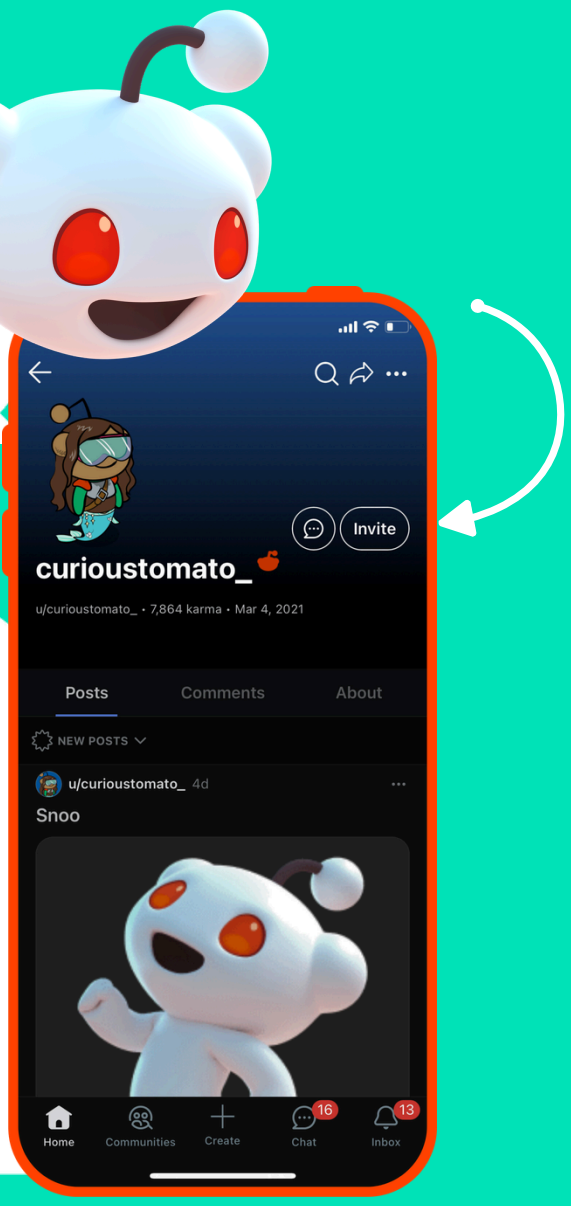
🔧 If this setting is for you, on Desktop navigate to **Mod Tools > Content Controls > Provide Members with Posting Guidelines.**

5. Post Types

The type of content allowed in your subreddit can set the vibe of your community. You can choose from three Post Type settings: Any Content Type (text, link, image, video), Text Only or Link Only.

🔧 The default setting is Any Content Type, but you have the flexibility to customize this setting. On mobile, adjust this setting via **Mod Tools > Post Types > Post Type options.**

Find your people



Grow your community

One way to grow your community is by inviting relevant redditors using the invite button, and then crafting a message inviting them to your new community.

Sample Message: Come hang out in the newest community for uncomfortable-looking rabbits, r/buncomfortable!

Community invite tips:

Do

- Invite redditors already interested in your topic
- Say what your community is about
- Be friendly

Don't

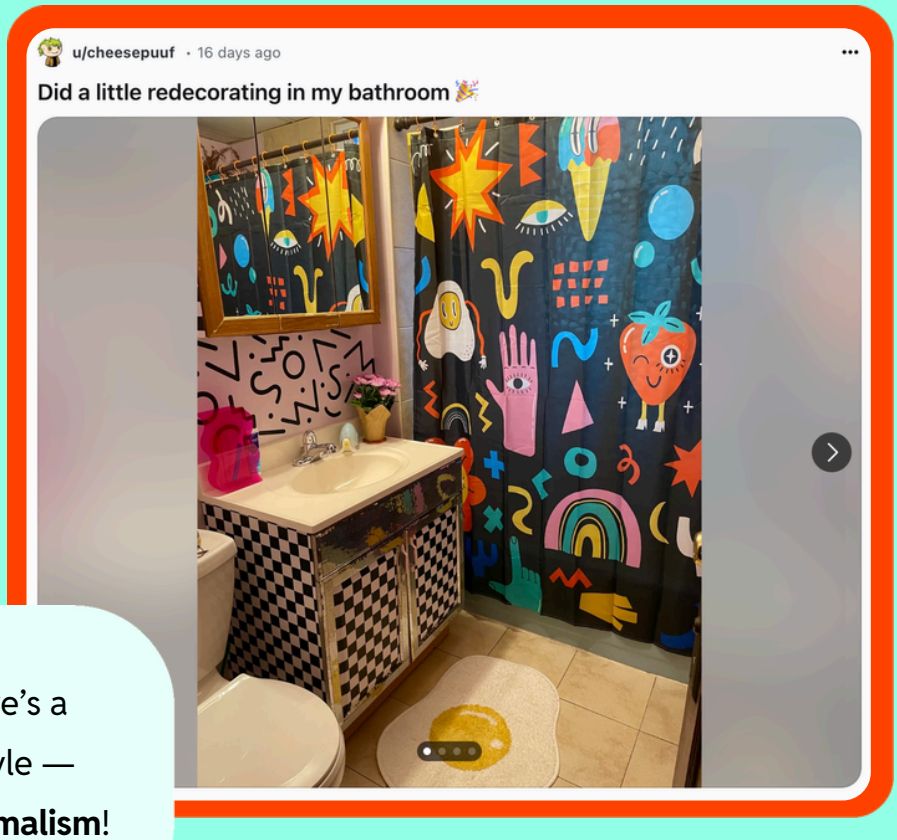
- Do not spam invites, you will become disabled from using it (aim for ~5 invites daily!).

Name-dropping

Another way to grow your community is by name-dropping your community name in relevant comment sections.

- Look for new or popular posts about your topic in related communities
- Determine the best place to add a comment to the thread
- Name-drop your community authentically!
- You wouldn't allow spammy comments in your community, so be authentic, not spammy!

Try leaving a comment!



Love your decor! There's a community for this style — you might like **r/maximalism**!

Staying safe as a moderator

Set yourself up for success by...

Reviewing the account you are moderating on and take care to remove personal information you would not want others to know about.

As you gain subscribers, consider **adding a moderator buddy** to help take part in managing comments and posts.

Safety FAQs

If my subreddit gets incorrectly closed, what should I do?
Read the Content Policy thoroughly. It's possible your community violated one of the rules. If this does not apply to you, file an appeal here.

Someone continues to harass my community, what do I do?
You can ban the user from your community via Mod Tools > User Management.

How do I report content that seems alarming, beyond removing the post?
If you need action taken by the admins for a *serious* issue, send a ModMail to r/ModSupport with the details.

Safety settings you should know

To find your safety settings, go to your **Moderation Tools** and click *Safety* under the *Settings* section.

Harassment Filter

The Harassment Filter allows moderators to automatically filter posts and comments that are likely to be considered harassment.

Reputation Filter

The Reputation Filter lets moderators automatically filter content by redditors who are likely to participate in unwanted behaviors such as spam.

Modmail Filtered Folder

This folder automatically filters inbound modmail messages that are likely to contain harassment. These messages will skip the inbox and go directly to a filtered folder.

Mod Tools Dictionary

Mod Log

Think of the Mod Log as a diary. When you or another member of your mod team takes an action in your community, the Mod Log automatically captures that action. You can use the Mod Log to see all mod actions taken by moderators of your community (or admins!). This tool is especially helpful if you have a large mod team.

Modmail

If a redditor sends a message to your subreddit mod team, it will appear in Mod Mail. Mod Mail is the shared messaging system that you can use to communicate with members of your community and other redditors. Admins may reach out to you through Mod Mail as well!

Queues

Mod Queue is like VIP holding area for pieces of content that warrant your review. The Needs Review queue within Mod Queue hosts content you should double-click on to see if it requires actioning.

Looking for an expanded guide to Mod Tools? Check out the help center here.

Mod Tools Dictionary

Queues (cont'd)

This includes user reports, and filtered posts and comments. Content removed by the spam filter will go into the Removed Queue.

As your community grows in engagement, this will be the number one place you tap in on each day to monitor what's happening.

Removal Reasons

Removal Reasons are short messages shown to redditors if you remove their content from your community. A common Removal Reason for new communities might be "*Spam - no outside links or self-promotion allowed.*"

Automations

In Automations you can set up a nifty feature called Post Guidance. Post Guidance will double-check a redditor's post before they post it to your community, to ensure the post follows your community rules. You can learn more here.

Looking for an expanded guide to Mod Tools? Check out the help center here.

New mod FAQs

I just created a subreddit...so what should I do first?

- Add a description to your community. The description should help potential visitors quickly understand what your community is all about!
- Add a Banner. This can only be done on Desktop.
- Add a Community Icon.
- Add at least 5 posts. Visitors will want to see that there are lights on in your community, before stepping through the door and committing. Adding five posts will also help you unlock your community rating faster, allowing your community to be found by others!

Is there a place where I can promote my community?

You can grow your community by finding posts already on Reddit that may be the perfect fit for your community as well! Search for related keywords to your topic on Reddit and sort by the last month. If you find a post that looks like a good fit for your community, comment on that post with something like “I’d love for you to post your content in my new community, it looks perfect!”

Tip: It’s very important to not be spammy in other communities and to only try this sparingly (~5 times per day).

How do I set up u/AutoModerator?

If you don’t have subscribers yet, you won’t need u/AutoModerator! It is best utilized by communities with thousands of subscribers. However, if you're feeling really savvy and curious, we recommend setting up Post Guidance. See this guide to get you started.

How do I change my subreddit name?

Your community name cannot be changed. If you made this community in error, just go ahead and make a new one.

New mod FAQs

How do I add a subreddit banner?

You can add a banner via desktop by navigating to Mod Tools > Community Appearance > Banner. The banner cannot be changed via the app.

Is it possible to see my subreddit members list?

You can see how many people subscribe to your community, but you cannot see the individual subscribers of your community.

How do I add/edit rules for my subreddit? Are there any standard rules I should add?

To add rules go to your Subreddit > Mod Tools > Rules and Removal Reasons. As a best practice, we recommend adding one rule: Be Kind. Check out your favorite communities or related communities for rule ideas.

How do I customize the name for “members online” in my community?

Navigate to Mod tools > Community Appearance > Sidebar Widgets > Community Details.

How do I get people to post to my community?

You’ll have to create content yourself in the beginning until you get subscribers. Try posting relevant news to your topic or find related content living in other communities and repost that content into your community. For more ideas, check out How to Encourage More Original Content.

I need help with something else. Where should I go to ask?

We recommend searching r/ModHelp or r/ModSupport to find an answer to your questions! If you need additional information regarding moderating or understanding tooling, check out the Moderator Help Center.

Resources available to you

For further reading:

- New Mod Checklist
- 3 Biggest Mistakes New Mods Make
- Advice from r/ModernistArchitecture on how to grow a community

Communities just for you:

r/modhelp

r/modsupport

r/ModEvents

r/ModNews

International:

🇬🇧 r/UKMods

🇮🇳 r/IndianMods

🇧🇷 r/ ModsBR

🇫🇷 r/ ModsFR

🇩🇪 r/deutschemods

Get Support:

Reddit Help Center

Report a problem